flight, as well as to connection across lines of division and difference. Modes of fear and survival are staged in Berlin in these works. Several other poems in *Our Dead Behind Us* have these themes or foci, some of which cloak allusions to Berlin in poetic imagery or were altered in the revision process. Lorde appears to have begun writing "Diaspora" in the United States; her drafts appear in an unpublished journal entry on January 30, 1984, before she left for Berlin.[74] Here she writes a clear vision for her forthcoming poem to confront the different manifestations of fear and what happens to the emotion when it passes.[75] The critical study and transformation of fear was an integral theme of Lorde's work and travels to Europe. Typed drafts of this poem appear in her papers dated May and July 1984. Here, as the poem eventually titled "Diaspora" emerges, readers understand the connections Lorde draws between fear and difference, American identity and exile, while conjuring and revising the poem in divided Berlin.

Lorde worked on "Diaspora" in West Berlin, and she imagined her experiences extending to her other travels in and beyond the spaces of U.S. military intervention, which included Cold War Germany. The term "diaspora" is recognized not only as a dispersal that transcends modern boundaries, but also as a form of militarized or politicized division that, once recognized, can be mined for creative and political projects.[76] She begins the poem with the line, "Afraid is a country with no exit visas."[77] In "Diaspora," Lorde problematizes national belonging. By referencing exit visas, she also nods to a key concern of East German activists working to achieve internal reforms of increased cross-border mobility. The Berlin Wall is both implied and extrapolated from here: the official state documentation and the controlled national borders delineate the hybrid country Lorde describes, but so do its horizons, outward stretches, and assembled topos. The adjoining of "Johannesburg Alabama" without extra spatial pausing or punctuation places the cities together in the shared space of the poetic line and thus joins them as mutually constitutive sites within Lorde's diasporic imagination and geographic rendering of repression. Lorde spends the poem naming and creating a roll call of other places, some actual and some imagined, to offer a vision of struggle, including the Shatila Refugee Camp in Lebanon and the "Braceras Grande." The latter is a wordplay on the Rio Grande but also the word *bracero*, or male manual laborer. Lorde offers the *bracera* as a female worker to present a womanist workforce in the context of the U.S.-Mexico border.[78] The rituals of return and flight here are accented by Lorde's poetic